

Heeyoung Lee

He/Him

Department of Sociology

University at Albany, State University of New York

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Education

Present	Ph.D. Candidate in Sociology, University at Albany, State University of New York, United States Dissertation: “Living Among the Educated: County Educational Contexts and Educational Mortality Gaps in the United States (2010-2022)” [Chair: Tse-Chuan Yang]
2020	M.A. Sociology, Chung Ang University, Korea
2017	B.A. Sociology, Kyung Hee University, Korea

Academic Interests

Population Health | Crime and Deviance | Life Course and Aging | Socio-ecological Approach
| Quantitative Research Methods | Spatial Analysis

Publications

Journal Articles (*equal 1st authorship)

- 2026. **Heeyoung Lee**, Permeable Boundaries: How Neighboring States’ Policy Environments Shape Local Mortality Rates in the United States. *Journal of Health and Social Behaviors*. (forthcoming)
- 2026. Tse-Chuan Yang, **Heeyoung Lee**, and Golam Morshed Suhel, Age Segregation and Deaths of Despair among Older Adults, 2010-2022: Rural/Urban County Comparisons. *Social Science and Medicine*.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socscimed.2026.119407>
- 2025. **Heeyoung Lee** and Tse-Chuan Yang. How Does County Educational Composition Affect Mortality? *Lerner Center Population Health Research Brief Series, Research Brief #139*. <https://doi.org/10.14305/rt.lerner.2025.22>
- 2025. **Heeyoung Lee** and Tse-Chuan Yang, Unequal Spillover of Human Capital: Longitudinal Analysis of Mortality Among Populations by College Degree in US Counties, 2010-2022. *American Journal of Preventive Medicine*.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.amepre.2025.107646>

2025. **Heeyoung Lee** and Matt Vogel. Exposure to Police Killing and Adolescents' Self-Concept: Diverging Effects for Black and White American Youths. *Journal of Adolescence*. <https://doi.org/10.1002/jad.12490>
2025. **Heeyoung Lee** and Seong-Jo Jung. Gender Differences in the Relationship between Coming Out as LGB to Family and Depression in South Korea. *Society and Mental Health*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/21568693241242400>
 *2024 Paul Meadows, Excellence in Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, University at Albany, SUNY*
2025. Tse-Chuan Yang, Carla Shoff, Kate Strully, and **Heeyoung Lee**. Features of Residential Counties and Individual Health Conditions for Opioid Use Disorder Among Older Medicare Beneficiaries. *The Journals of Gerontology, Series B: Psychological Sciences and Social Sciences*.
<https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbaf069>
2025. Seong-Jo Jung, **Heeyoung Lee**, and Chan. S. Suh. Moving Apart and Coming Together: The Dynamics of Coalition Building in the Case of South Korean LGBTQ Movement. *Journal of Homosexuality*.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/00918369.2024.2378743>
2024. **Heeyoung Lee** and Tse-Chuan Yang. Spatial and Temporal Dimension of Black-White Mental Health Paradox in the US: Effect of Cumulative Neighborhood Disadvantage. *Population Research & Policy Review*.
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s11113-024-09922-2>
2024. **Heeyoung Lee**. State-Level Structural Sexism and Adolescent Sexual Violence Victimization in the US. *Child Abuse and Neglect*.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chiabu.2024.107096>
2024. **Heeyoung Lee**. Delinquency During Puberty as a Biosocial Behavior: Time-Varying Effects of Social Contexts on Girl's Delinquency in South Korea. *Criminal Justice and Behaviors*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00938548241276087>
 *2022 Paul Meadows, Excellence in Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, University at Albany, SUNY*
2024. **Heeyoung Lee**, Sooyeon Moon, and Na-Young Lee. Industry Culture Matters: Sexual Harassment in the South Korean Film Industry. *Violence Against Women*.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/10778012231203001>
2023. Seong-Jo Jung and **Heeyoung Lee**. Open, Discreet, and Repressive Closet: Latent Class Analysis on the Patterns of LGBTQ+ Youth's Coming Out. *The Korean Journal of Sociology* [in Korean]
 *2023 Graduate Student Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, Chung-Ang University*
2021. **Heeyoung Lee**, Dawool Cheong, and Seoung-Jo Jung. A Democratic Response to COVID-19 or Governance with People Without Rights. *Memory & Vision* [in Korean]
 *2021 Democracy Academic Paper Contest Winner, Korean Democracy Foundation*

 2022 Academic Paper Award Winner, People's Solidarity for Participatory Democracy

- 2019. **Heeyoung Lee** and Na-Young Lee. Constituting 'Premature Girls' during the 1960s-70s in South Korea: A Gendered Regime of Sexual Efficiency. *The Journal of Asian Women* [in Korean]
- 2019. **Heeyoung Lee** and Na-Young Lee. Constructing the National Body: Child Development in the Postcolonial Nation-State during the 1960s-1970s. *Society and History* [in Korean]

Working Papers

1. Tse-Chuan Yang, Carla Shoff, **Heeyoung Lee**, and Kiwoong Park, Research Note: Opioid Use Disorder Diagnosis during the COVID-19 Pandemic and Mortality Rates among Older Medicare Beneficiaries in the US (*RnR at Demography*)
2. **Heeyoung Lee**, Jungmin Shin, and Jonathan Dirlam, Structural Sexism and Sexual Harassment (*RnR at The Sociological Quarterly*)
3. Matt Vogel, **Heeyoung Lee**, Taylor Kaser, and Yoobin Kim, Misappropriating Vulnerability: Assessing the Social Vulnerability Index as a Predictor of Firearm Violence (*RnR at PLOS One*)
4. Matt Vogel, **Heeyoung Lee***, Byunggu (Gu) Kang, and Taylor Kaser, The Lethality of Violent Crime and the Pandemic-Era Homicide Surge (*Under Review at Nature Communications*)
5. Yeeun Hong and **Heeyoung Lee***, Selectivity, Assimilation, and the Limits of Education: Immigrant Mortality Trajectories Among Asian and Hispanic Populations in the US (*Under Review at Sociology of Race and Ethnicity*)
6. Seong-Jo Jeong, Bomi Kim, **Heeyoung Lee**, and Hyemin Lee, Substance Use and Mental Health Outcomes among Gay and Bisexual Men in South Korea: A Cross-Sectional Study (*Under Review at Addictive Behavior Report*)
7. Yuna Lee and **Heeyoung Lee**, Policing at Racial Borders: Contested Boundaries and Race-Specific Enforcement in New York City (*draft available*)
8. **Heeyoung Lee** and Patricia Homan, Long-Term Effect of Structural Racism on Subjective Cardiopulmonary Symptoms in the U.S. (*draft available*)
9. **Heeyoung Lee**, and Matt Vogel, Privilege or Threat: American Youth Responses to Contested Racial Boundaries (*draft available*)
10. **Heeyoung Lee**, Geographic Structure of Health Disparities in the US: Decomposing Compositional and Contextual Effects Across Census Tracts, Counties, and States (*draft available*)
11. Kate Strully, **Heeyoung Lee**, Chris Lowenstein, and David Rehkoph, Refundable Tax Credits and Income Inequality Across the United States (*drafting*)
12. Scott Schieman and **Heeyoung Lee**, Social Distance Fallout: Isolation During and After the COVID-19 Pandemic (*drafting*)

Survey Project Participation

- 2026. 2026 Measuring Employment Sentiments and Social Inequality (PI: Scott Schieman)
- 2026. Labor Rights and Discrimination of Sexual and Gender Minorities (PI: Seong-Jo Jeong)
- 2024. 2023 Sexual Harassment in the Film Industry Survey (PI: Na-Young Lee)
- 2021. 2020 Sexual Harassment in the Film Industry Survey (PI: Na-Young Lee)
- 2019. Youth's Attitude Towards Gender (PI: Na-Young Lee)

Awards, Grants, Scholarships

- 2026. UAlbany Graduate Student Association Professional Development Grant
- 2025. UAlbany Graduate Student Association Professional Development Grant
- 2025. Hak-Bong Research Grant, School of Law, Seoul National University
- 2024. BIPOC Junior Scholar Travel Grant, ASA Section on Aging and the Life Course
- 2024. Paul Meadows, Excellence in Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, University at Albany, SUNY
- 2024. Korean Student Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, Chung-Ang University
- 2023. UAlbany Graduate Student Association Professional Development Grant
- 2022. Democracy Academic Paper Award Winner, People's Solidarity for Participatory Democracy
- 2022. Paul Meadows, Excellence in Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, University at Albany, SUNY
- 2021. UAlbany Graduate Student Employees Union Travel Grant
- 2021. UAlbany Graduate Student Association Professional Development Grant
- 2021. Academic Paper Contest Winner, Korean Democracy Foundation
- 2021. Scholarship, Department of Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY

Conference Presentations

- 2026. Early Exposure to Structural Racism and Cardiopulmonary Symptoms in Midlife in the United States, Population Association of America (PAA) 2026 Annual Meeting, Paper Session, St. Louis, May 6–9.
- 2026. Refundable Tax Credits and Income Inequality Across the United States, Population Association of America (PAA) 2026 Annual Meeting, Paper Session, St. Louis, May 6–9.
- 2025. Spatial Spillover Effect of State Policy Liberalism and Mortality in the U.S., 120th ASA Annual Meeting, Paper Session, Chicago, Aug. 8-12.
- 2024. Racialized Cumulative Effect of Early Neighborhood Disadvantage on Mental Health

- Paradox, 119th ASA Annual Meeting, Paper Session, Montreal, Aug. 9-13.
2024. Stress among Sexual Minorities in South Korea: An Analysis of Internalized Homophobia and Community Connectedness, 18th International Stress Conference, Portland, June. 8-10.
2023. What Did I Come Out For? Coming Out Network and Its Adverse Effects Among South Korean LGBTQ Youth, 118th ASA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, Aug. 17-21.
2023. Reciprocal risks of psychological distress between immigrant mothers and children in South Korea, Eastern Sociological Society Conference 2023, Baltimore, Feb. 23-26.
2022. Moving Apart and Coming Together: The Dynamics of Coalition Building in the Case of the South Korean LGBT Movement, 117th ASA Annual Meeting, Roundtable, Los Angeles, Aug. 5-9.
2021. Moving Apart and Coming Together: The Dynamics of Coalition Building in the Case of the South Korean LGBT Movement. 2021 Korean Sociological Association Annual Academic Conference, Online, Dec. 18, 2021.

Teaching Experiences

2026 Spring	Adjunct Instructor, Criminology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY
2026 Spring	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY
2025 Fall	Adjunct Instructor, Criminology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.73/5.00]
2025 Fall	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.81/5.00]
2025 Summer	Teaching Assistant, The 12th KOSTAT-UNFPA Summer Seminar on Population, Instructor: Scott Yabiku (Sociology, Penn State University)
2025 Summer	Adjunct Instructor, Criminology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.75/5.00]
2025 Spring	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.76/5.00]
2024 Fall	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.78/5.00]
2024 Summer	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.80/5.00]
2023 Spring	Co-Instructor, Statistics for Sociologists, Instructor: Kate Strully (Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY)

Professional Services and Activities

Peer-Review

Social Science and Research; Population Research and Policy Review; Socius; Society and Mental Health; American Journal of Preventive Medicine Focus; Journal of Homosexuality

Memberships

Present	Member, American Sociological Association (ASA) Section on Medical Sociology Section on Aging and Life Course Section on Population
Present	Member, Population Association of America (PAA)
Present	Member, International Sociological Association (ISA)
Present	Member, Korean Sociological Association (KSA)
2023-2025	Founding Member, Quantitative Research Group (QRG) in Sociology Department at the University at Albany, SUNY

Skills

R, STATA, PYTHON, SPSS, SAS, JAMOVİ, ArcGIS, GeoDa, UCINET (NetDraw)

References

Tse-Chuan Yang
Professor, Sociology, University at Albany,
SUNY

Jonathan Dirlam
Assistant Professor, Sociology, University at
Albany, SUNY

Scott Schieman
Professor, Sociology, University of Toronto

Kate Strully
Associate Professor, Sociology, University at
Albany, SUNY

Matt Vogel
Associate Professor, Criminal Justice,
University at Albany, SUNY

Patricia Homan
Associate Professor, Sociology, Florida State
University